

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1252

By Howell

A RESOLUTION to honor Ocoee Church of God on the occasion of its fiftieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pride in honoring those faith-based institutions whose steadfast service and spiritual leadership have strengthened their communities and positively influenced the lives of countless citizens; and

WHEREAS, the churches of our nation have been an integral part of our history as a people and have had an unparalleled impact in forming and maintaining a stable and just society; and

WHEREAS, one such dynamic and historic community of faith is Ocoee Church of God, whose members are celebrating the church's fiftieth anniversary this year; and

WHEREAS, established in 1976, the Ocoee Church of God, located in Ocoee in Polk County, will commemorate fifty years of ministry and service on May 31, 2026, marking a significant milestone of faith, dedication, and community impact; and

WHEREAS, the Ocoee Church of God was founded by Pastors Robert "Bob" Lee Whitmire and Jean Whitmire, whose faithful leadership and vision guided the church for many years until Pastor Bob's passing in 2001; and

WHEREAS, in February 2020, Pastors Michael "Mike" Lee Whitmire and Sandy Whitmire answered the call to lead the Ocoee Church of God, continuing the Whitmire family's legacy of ministry nineteen years after the passing of Pastor Bob Whitmire; and

WHEREAS, throughout its fifty-year history, the Ocoee Church of God has faithfully disciplined and mentored numerous church leaders, singers, musicians, teachers, and pastors who are now ministering throughout Tennessee, across the United States, and around the world

and consistently demonstrates compassion, generosity, and commitment to meeting the spiritual and practical needs of the communities it serves; and

WHEREAS, the church's welcoming and loving spirit reflects its mission to be a place where all individuals are received with dignity and respect, regardless of their background or circumstance, and where unity is fostered through a shared faith grounded in the love of Christ; and

WHEREAS, guided by the belief that the Holy Bible is the infallible Word of God, the Ocoee Church of God has remained steadfast in its commitment to biblical teaching, spiritual growth, and community outreach; and

WHEREAS, under the leadership of Pastors Mike and Sandy Whitmire, the church currently operates more than twenty-four outreach ministries, including GriefShare Ministry, Children's Ministry, Youth Ministry, Men's and Women's Ministries, Benevolence Ministry, Hope Squad, and Care Team Ministries, all serving individuals and families from its home in Ocoee; and

WHEREAS, the Ocoee Church of God's legacy of faithful ministry has strengthened families, uplifted individuals, and enriched the spiritual life of the region for five decades; and

WHEREAS, thanks to the church's faith, leadership, and strength of its members, Ocoee Church of God has persevered and continues to be a light in the community; it is truly one of the great religious institutions and catalysts for positive spiritual change in our State and nation, and the members of this exceptional congregation should be appropriately honored for their exemplary service to their fellow Christians and to the good people of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Ocoee Church of God upon the celebration of

its fiftieth anniversary, commending its enduring commitment to faith, service, and the well-being of the citizens of Polk County and surrounding communities and extend our best wishes for much continued success in the future.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sincere appreciation to Pastors Mike and Sandy Whitmire, as well as to the past and present leaders and members of the congregation, for their faithful dedication and positive impact over the past fifty years.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.